

result someone could have reported
What our own replication retracted

the control we ran against it

what it returned

Argmax over-reports a mass shift near the boundary	→	Fresh option orderings re-run, seeds 4-7	→	retracted sign not stable
Tuning-localized tuned model's negative report collapsed	→	Fresh option orderings same code, seeds 4-7	→	retracted +0.0002 → +0.1126
Depth-robust null at all seven depths	→	Fresh option orderings same items and layers	→	retracted moves at layers 18, 24
Shell represented, not expressed	→	Fresh option orderings same probe	→	retracted options move too

The nuisance, measured over its whole population

Baseline negative mass one quantity, before injection	→	All 120 orderings enumerated, no injection	→	986× range 0.0009 to 0.8820
The mechanism what explains the range	→	Five identical options nothing but position differs	→	87% on slot A 0.33% on the middle
Is the format broken? or the question undetermined	→	Known-answer canary same five-option format	→	97.9% correct stable across orderings
One model only? or a tuning property	→	Eight base/instruct pairs four families	→	tuned worse in 4 of 4 families

What survives on a working instrument

A state outlives its cause injected, then its vector erased	→	Project the direction OUT of the residual stream	→	86% survives at layer 30
The field's standard control is a weak null	→	Direction fit on shuffled labels same procedure, random targets	→	0.045 shift where random moves ≈ 0